NATIONAL GOVERNMENT
CONSTITUENCIES DEVELOPMENT FUND

Maendeleo kwa Wote · NG-CDF OCEO

Activity Memo Testing Guide

4 November 2026

This guide explains what has changed in the activity memo and how to test it. Work through each section, tick the checks, and note anything that looks wrong. You do not need any technical knowledge.

1	6	2
page to prepare a whole memo	numbered steps for the Head of Department	routes: through COS/ACOS or direct to CEO

What has changed

1. **One page for the whole memo:** a Head of Department now prepares a memo on a single page, in six numbered steps, instead of moving between the memo form, the team page and the memo page. The work is saved as a draft along the way, so they can stop and come back later.
2. **Step 1 must be complete:** every field under "About the activity" must be filled in before step 2 opens. Spaces alone do not count.
3. **Officer link uses the same page:** when a Head of Department asks an officer to prepare a memo through a link, the officer sees the same step by step page (five steps).
4. **Two routes:** when submitting, the Head chooses "Through COS/ACOS" (as before) or "Direct to CEO". A direct memo goes only to the CEO. The Chief of Staff and the Assistant can read it but cannot comment, edit or decide on it.
5. **Dates:** the memo now takes a planned start date and an expected completion date. The number of days and nights is worked out for you.
6. **Officer days:** when changing the days an officer takes part, you now pick the first and last day, and the popup shows the days and nights.
7. **Cost lines:** a cost can be per person (unit cost times number of people) or a fixed amount for the activity. The total is worked out for you.
8. **External participants:** people from outside NG-CDF can have a designation, their own dates and a payment rate (a DSA scale, or a custom amount per night, per day or once).
9. **New categories and roles:** categories "Policy and Management" and "Other" (you type what it is; "Other" is always last). Roles Director, CEO, HOD, Officer and Other.
10. **Generated memo:** FROM shows the Head's designation, not the department name. A memo sent direct to the CEO has no "Reviewed" or "Validated" signature blocks.
11. **Screen fixes:** no more empty white space below the page, page titles are no longer squashed, and tables fit on phones.

Before you start

Accounts: you need a Head of Department account, a Chief of Staff or Assistant account, and the CEO account on the test site.

Officer for the link test: pick an officer on the staff list whose email or mobile number is yours, so the six digit code comes to you and not to a real officer.

Phone and laptop: try the main test on a laptop and at least once on a phone.

Test 1: Head of Department prepares a memo

Sign in as the Head of Department and click to create a new activity memo.

Step	What to do and what to check
The page	All six steps are listed on the left (on a phone, as buttons across the top). Clicking a step jumps to it. Steps 2 to 6 show a lock until they open.
1. About the activity	Leave a field empty and click "Continue to step 2". You should see a message on each empty field and step 2 should stay locked. Type only spaces in a field: it should still be refused. Fill everything in: step 2 opens and the page moves to it. If the category has activity types, the type is required. Choose "Other" and check you must type what it is.
2. Reference, dates and budget	Enter the REF NO, the date, the planned start and expected completion. Check the days and nights shown are right. Click "Save draft and continue". The page should not reload or take you away, and steps 3 to 6 should open.

3. Venue and location	Add a location with a county and a venue. Try to add one with nothing filled in: you should be asked for a county or a venue. Remove a location.
4. Team	Add officers one by one and as a group by number. Change an officer's days using the first and last day. Try an officer already on another approved activity on the same days: you should be warned and not be able to add them.
5. Costs	Add a per person cost and a fixed cost. Check the totals. DSA lines appear by themselves and cannot be typed in.
6. Review and submit	The checklist shows what is still missing. Attach a document. Click "Preview memo" and check the PDF. Submit and choose a route. You should land on the memo page with a success message.
Saving and coming back	Change something without saving: "Unsaved changes" appears at the bottom. Save, leave the page, then open the memo again with "Continue editing". Everything you entered should still be there.

Test 2: Officer prepares a memo through a link

1. **Send the link:** as the Head of Department, ask the chosen officer to prepare a memo.
2. **Open the link:** click "Send me a code", enter the six digit code and click "Open the memo".
3. **Check the page:** it looks like the Head's page, with five steps: About the activity, Dates, venue and budget, Team, Costs, Check and submit.
4. **Step 1 rule:** the same as Test 1. Step 2 must stay locked until every field is filled in.
5. **Submit:** send the memo to the Head of Department. While the officer has it, the Head should not be able to edit it.
6. **Head's side:** the Head can return it to the officer (a new link is sent), decline it, or send it on.

Test 3: The two routes

Route	What to check
Through COS/ACOS	The memo goes to the office you chose. They can comment, return it or forward it to the CEO. A returned memo goes back to the Head, who resubmits it the same way.
Direct to CEO	Only the CEO is told. The Chief of Staff and Assistant can open it but cannot comment, edit, postpone or decide. If the CEO returns it, it goes back to the Head, not to COS/ACOS. The memo PDF has no Reviewed or Validated blocks.

Test 4: The generated memo PDF

FROM: shows the Head's designation. If they ticked "acting", it starts with "Ag.".

Dates: the start, completion, days and nights match what was entered.

Costs: every cost line and total matches the Costs step, including per person lines and external payments.

Category and roles: "Other" shows the text that was typed.

Other things to look at

White space: scroll to the bottom of each page. There should be no large empty area below the content.

Phones: page titles are not squashed and tables do not push the page wider than the screen.

Office of the CEO: the CEO, Chief of Staff and Assistant still use their own activity form, unchanged.

Submitted memos: once a memo is with the Office of the CEO, the Head can no longer open it for editing.

> **Reporting a problem:** write down the account you used, the memo reference, the step, what you did, what you expected and what happened. Add a screenshot if you can.